of the KLF, which was the establishment of an independent state. The achieving of one of the other KLF objectives was the protection of Sikh people from violence or torture. In the words of the Australian judge, 'There is no bright line between crimes that are political and those that are non-political.'[13] This is because '[i]t may be doubted that the image of the clinical assassin, with a narrow focus upon an oppressive dictator, taking care to avoid what would now be called collateral damage, ever bore much relation to reality'. More strikingly still, he observed how '[w]hile homicide is foreign to our experience of political conflict, that is because we have been favoured with a relatively peaceful history. At other times, and in other places, the taking of life has been, and is, an incident of political action.'[14] The judge even went onto say, 'It is difficult to imagine serious conflict of any kind without the possibility that parties to the conflict will seek retribution for past wrongs, real or imagined. Revenge is not the antithesis of political struggle; it is one of its most common features.'[15]

In fact, Frantz Fanon, the political philosopher from the French colony of Martinique had something to say about this. His work today is hugely influential in the disciplines of postcolonial studies and critical theory. He wrote from experience having suffered racism as a French West Indian psychiatrist. In his 1961 book *The Wretched of the Earth*, he has a long[16] chapter titled 'Concerning Violence'. Here he writes that '[n]ational liberation, national renaissance, the restoration of nationhood to the people' or 'whatever may be the headings used' meant that 'decolonisation is always a violent phenomenon'. This is because 'decolonisation is quite simply the replacing of a certain "species" of men by another "species" of men. Without any period of transition, there is a total, complete and absolute substitution' and 'the proof of success lies in a whole social structure being changed from the bottom up'.[17] Like Bhagat Singh who emphasized the occurrence of earthly tremors, he also wrote that '[d]ecolonisation, which sets out to change the order of the world, is obviously a programme of complete disorder' and this is because '[d]ecolonisation is the meeting of two forces, opposed to each other by their very nature . . .'.[18]